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Écosystème startup et entrepreneuriat en Tunisie : guide complet

Verified data

Impôt sur les sociétés (%)	20 % (taux général), porté de 15 % à 20 % par la loi de finances 2025. Taux réduit de 10 % (artisanat, agriculture, pêche, coopératives, zones de développement régional). Taux majorés : 35 % (télécoms, hypermarchés, concessionnaires automobiles, sociétés d'investissement, services pétroliers, établissements de paiement) et 40 % (banques, établissements financiers, assurances et réassurances). (%) — depuis 01/2025	PwC Worldwide Tax Summaries — Tunisia, Taxes on corporate income (page revue le 29 juin 2026) taxsummaries.pwc.com checked on 06/08/2026
TVA (%)	19 % (taux normal), en vigueur depuis le 1er janvier 2018. Taux réduits de 13 % et 7 %. (%) — depuis 01/2018	PwC Worldwide Tax Sum — Tunisia, Corporate/O taxes (page revue le 29 ju 2026) taxsummaries.pwc.com checked on 06/08/2026

These figures are sourced and dated: where the text below differs, these prevail.

Informational guide written with AI assistance. Figures (minimum wage, contributions, severance) and legal rules change over time: please confirm them with the country's official sources before acting. This is not legal advice.

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Tunisia's Startup Ecosystem in Full Expansion

Tunisia is establishing itself as a major technology hub in North Africa, with a dynamic entrepreneurial ecosystem supported by legislative reforms and growing investments. The country now has more than 300 active startups, mainly concentrated in the fintech, e-commerce, and information technology sectors.

Legislative and Regulatory Framework

Startup Law. Law No. 2018-20 of April 17, 2018 on startups constitutes the legal foundation for innovative entrepreneurship in Tunisia. This law precisely defines the startup status and offers significant tax advantages:

- Total tax exemption for 8 years for labeled startups
- 50% reduction in employer social security contributions
- Simplified business creation procedures
- Possibility of raising funds from foreign investors

Eligibility conditions for the startup label. To benefit from startup status in Tunisia, the company must meet the following criteria:

1. Less than 8 years old since its creation
2. Annual turnover not exceeding 10 million TND
3. Innovative nature of the product or service
4. Potential for rapid growth
5. At least 51% of the capital held by natural persons

Main Support Structures

Public Incubators and Accelerators

- **Flat6Labs Tunis**: Leading accelerator with 4 programs per year, funding up to 200,000 TND
- **WikiStartup**: Tunisia's first private incubator, more than 50 startups supported
- **Cogite Coworking Space**: Co-working and incubation space in Tunis
- **Start Palace**: Incubator specialized in emerging technologies

University Structures. Tunisian universities are developing their own incubators:

- **ESPRIT Incubator**: Affiliated with the Private Higher School of Engineering and Technology
- **University of Carthage**: University incubator with a focus on applied research
- **ISET**: Network of incubators within the Higher Institutes of Technological Studies

Available Funding Sources

Local Investment Funds. Tunisia's financial ecosystem is gradually becoming richer:

- **Tuninvest Technology Partners**: Venture capital fund of USD 50 million
- **AfricInvest**: Present in Tunisia with several sector-specific funds
- **Capsa Capital Partners**: Growth capital investment fund
- **BFPME**: Bank for the Financing of Small and Medium Enterprises, with a credit line dedicated to startups

Government Programs. The Tunisian State supports entrepreneurship through several mechanisms:

1. **National Fund for the Promotion of Crafts and Small Trades (FONAPRAM)**
2. **Tunisian Solidarity Bank (BTS)**: Micro-loans for young entrepreneurs
3. **Upgrading Program (PMN)**: Support for business modernization
4. **Industrial Promotion and Decentralization Fund (FOPRODI)**

Crowdfunding. Crowdfunding is developing with platforms such as:

- **CoFundy**: Tunisia's first crowdfunding platform
- **Jumpstart**: Regional platform active in Tunisia

Promising Sectors and Opportunities

Information Technology. A historically strong sector with more than 1,800 companies and 85,000 jobs. Main opportunities:

- Software development for export
- Offshore IT services
- Artificial intelligence and blockchain
- Cybersecurity

Fintech. A rapidly expanding market with startups such as:

- **Paymi**: Mobile payment solution
- **Kaoun**: Digital payment platform

- **MoneyFellows**: Crowdfunding

AgTech. A promising sector given the weight of agriculture (10% of GDP):

- Precision agriculture
- Smart irrigation systems
- Traceability of agricultural products
- Agricultural marketplace

Challenges and Recommendations

Main Obstacles

- **Access to funding**: Significant gap between seed capital and Series A funding rounds
- **Limited local market**: Need to target international markets quickly
- **Brain drain**: Emigration of talent to Europe and the Gulf
- **Bureaucracy**: Administrative procedures still complex despite reforms

Success Strategies

1. **Early internationalization**: Target African and European markets
2. **Strategic partnerships**: Collaborate with major Tunisian groups
3. **Continuous training**: Invest in skills development
4. **Professional network**: Participate in ecosystem events

Events and Communities

Tunisia's startup ecosystem thrives around regular events:

- **Startup Weekend Tunis**: Monthly business creation event
- **Tunisia Startup Cup**: Annual national competition
- **Digital Mania**: Technology and innovation trade show
- **Invest in Tunisia Forum**: Annual gathering of investors

Tunisia offers a favorable environment for technological entrepreneurship, reinforced by advantageous legislation and an ecosystem taking shape. Entrepreneurs benefit from an attractive tax framework and facilitated access to regional and European markets.

FAQ

- Quel est le coût de la vie en Tunisie ?
- Comment est la culture du travail en Tunisie ?
- Quels sont les transports à Tunis et comment s'y déplacer ?

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Types of employment contracts in Tunisia: permanent contracts (CDI), fixed-term contracts (CDD), and internships.

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